	(in thousands) Year Ended December 31,		
	2009	2008	2007
Net sales [1]:			
Electronic Instruments	$1,146,578	$1,402,653	$1,199,757
Electromechanical	951,777	1,128,482	937,093
Consolidated net sales	$2,098,355	$2,531,135	$2,136,850

		% of Sales		**% of Sales**		**% of Sales**
Operating income [2]:						
Segment operating income:						
Electronic Instruments	$ 232,875	20.3	$ 306,764	21.9	$ 260,338	21.7
Electromechanical	166,582	17.5	175,181	15.5	167,166	17.8
Total segment operating income	399,457	19.0	481,945	19.0	427,504	20.0
Corporate administrative and other expenses	(33,407)	(1.6)	(49,291)	(1.9)	(40,930)	(1.9)
Consolidated operating income	$ 366,050	17.4	$ 432,654	17.1	$ 386,574	18.1

(1) After elimination of intra- and intersegment sales, which are not significant in amount.

(2) Segment operating income represents sales less all direct costs and expenses (including certain administrative and other expenses) applicable to each segment, but does not include interest expense.

New orders for 2009 were $2,028.1 million, a decrease of $533.4 million or 20.8% when compared with $2,561.5 million in 2008. Throughout most of 2009, the Company experienced lower order rates as a result of the global economic recession. However, order rates stabilized in the third quarter of 2009 and began to increase in the fourth quarter of 2009, compared with the previous quarters of 2009 and the fourth quarter of 2008. As a result, the Company's backlog of unfilled orders at December 31, 2009 was $648.4 million, a decrease of $70.2 million or 9.8% when compared with $718.6 million at December 31, 2008.

Segment operating income for 2009 was $399.5 million, a decrease of $82.4 million or 17.1% when compared with segment operating income of $481.9 million in 2008. Segment operating income, as a percentage of sales, was 19.0% in both 2009 and 2008. The decrease in segment operating income resulted primarily from the decrease in sales noted above and higher defined benefit pension expense, partially offset by profit contributions made by the acquisitions and cost reduction initiatives, including $135 million of cost savings achieved in 2009 primarily from the restructuring activities related to fourth quarter of 2008 restructuring charges. The fourth quarter of 2008 restructuring resulted in pretax charges totaling $40.0 million, which had the effect of reducing net income by $27.3 million ($0.25 per diluted share). These charges include restructuring costs for employee reductions and facility closures ($32.6 million), as well as asset write-downs ($7.4 million). Of the $40.0 million in charges, $32.9 million of the restructuring charges and asset write-downs were recorded in cost of sales and $7.1 million of the restructuring charges and asset write-downs were recorded in Selling, General and Administrative ("SG&A") expenses. As a result of defined benefit pension plan contributions in 2009 and 2008, as well as overall stock market performance in 2009, the Company expects defined benefit pension expense to be lower in 2010 than in 2009.

SG&A expenses for 2009 were $254.1 million, a decrease of $68.5 million or 21.2% when compared with $322.6 million in 2008. As a percentage of sales, SG&A expenses were 12.1% for 2009, compared with 12.7% in 2008. The decrease in SG&A expenses was primarily the result of lower sales and the Company's cost savings initiatives. Additionally, 2008 SG&A expenses include both a $7.1 million charge, recorded in corporate administrative expenses, related to the accelerated vesting of an April 2005 restricted stock grant in the second quarter of 2008 and $7.1 million of SG&A expense related to fourth quarter of 2008 restructuring charges and asset write-downs. Base business selling expenses decreased approximately 22%, which was in line with the Company's 2009 sales decline. Selling expenses, as a percentage of sales, decreased to 10.5% for 2009, compared with 10.8% in 2008 due to the previously mentioned cost savings initiatives.

Corporate administrative expenses for 2009 were $33.2 million, a decrease of $16.0 million or 32.5% when compared with $49.2 million in 2008. As a percentage of sales, corporate administrative expenses were 1.6% for 2009, compared with 1.9% in 2008. The decrease in corporate administrative expenses was driven by the equity-based compensation associated with the accelerated vesting of restricted stock in the second quarter of 2008, lower short-term incentive compensation in 2009 and the Company's cost savings initiatives, including the restructuring activities, noted above.